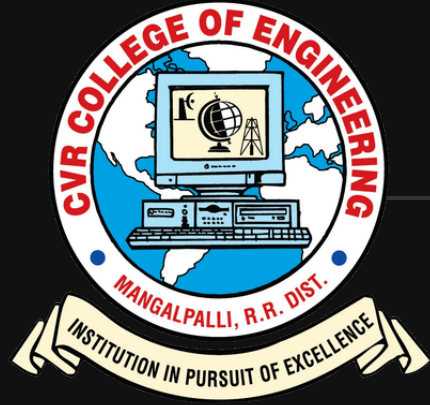




# CVR COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

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Department of CSE

B.Tech CSE - II Year II Semester

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# NOTO

*A Web-Based Thinking, Note making and Collaboration Ecosystem*

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# INTRODUCTION

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## Problem Domain

- Learning and collaboration today happen across fragmented tools — whiteboards, note-taking apps, document viewers, and messaging platforms.
- This fragmentation disrupts thinking flow, reduces clarity, and increases cognitive load for users.

## Project Objective

- Noto provides a single unified digital space where users can think, learn, collaborate, and retain knowledge effectively.
  - Built around a shared infinite canvas with an embedded AI assistance layer for seamless workflow integration.
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PROBLEM DEFINITION

Core Issue: Existing digital tools focus on either collaboration or note-taking, but rarely both in an integrated and context-aware manner.

Key Problems Identified

|                                                                                                 |                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>01</div> <div>No unified platform for visual thinking combined with structured notes</div> | <div>02</div> <div>Poor integration between documents and freeform thinking spaces</div>     |
| <div>03</div> <div>Limited real-time collaboration in learning-focused tools</div>              | <div>04</div> <div>AI tools exist separately — not embedded into the thinking workflow</div> |

EXISTING WORK AND METHODS

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|                             |                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Online Whiteboards       | Enable real-time collaborative drawing and brainstorming but lack structured note-taking or document integration.   |
| 2. Note-Taking Applications | Support personal study and organization but are primarily single-user with limited freeform or visual capabilities. |
| 3. Document Readers         | Provide basic annotation features on PDFs but do not support dynamic collaboration or AI-driven assistance.         |
| 4. Standalone AI Tools      | Offer summarization and explanation features but operate outside the user's core workspace, breaking context.       |

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*Critical Gap: These tools work independently, forcing users to switch contexts frequently and disrupting the natural flow of thinking.*

## CHALLENGES IN EXISTING SYSTEMS

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- Fragmented user experience across multiple tools with no unified interface

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- Lack of deep integration between document viewers and personal note-taking

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- Collaboration tools are not optimized for structured learning environments

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- AI assistance is not context-aware or embedded within the thinking workspace

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- High cognitive overload from managing and switching between multiple platforms

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L I T E R A T U R E   R E V I E W

|         |                                                                                                                       |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ref [1] | Online collaborative tools improve group learning outcomes but lack personalization and individual context retention. |
| Ref [2] | AI-based summarization techniques significantly improve learning retention and knowledge recall.                      |
| Ref [3] | Visual note-taking methods enhance conceptual understanding and long-term memory.                                     |
| Ref [4] | Real-time collaboration systems measurably improve student engagement and participation.                              |
| Ref [5] | Integrated learning environments reduce cognitive load and improve task completion rates.                             |

*Conclusion: These studies collectively motivate the need for a unified, AI-assisted thinking platform that combines benefits of all reviewed approaches.*

# PROPOSED SOLUTION OVERVIEW

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## Noto: Core Architecture

A web-based thinking and collaboration ecosystem built around three foundational components:

- 1 Shared Infinite Canvas Engine
- 2 Common AI Intelligence Layer
- 3 Multiple Context-Aware Usage Modes

## System Adaptability

The platform adapts to three primary user contexts, enabling a consistent experience across varied workflows:

- Collaborative Learning**  
Multi-user shared canvas with live synchronization
- Individual Study**  
Document annotation with AI-based explanations
- Personal Thinking**  
Freeform planning, mind mapping, and note retention

PROPOSED METHOD

Technical Approach

- A single canvas engine reused and shared across all application modes
- A mode-based architecture that enables or disables features based on context
- A backend-mediated AI layer for consistent, centralized intelligence
- A client–server architecture with real-time synchronization support

Key Benefits

Scalability

Canvas engine scales to handle many concurrent users

Modularity

Each component is independently deployable and testable

Clarity

Separation of concerns keeps system design maintainable



# SYSTEM MODULES

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01

**User Authentication**

Manages user registration, secure login, and session handling across all modes.

02

**Canvas Management**

Handles infinite canvas creation, persistent storage, and retrieval per user.

03

**Collaboration & Real-Time**

Enables multi-user synchronization, live cursors, and instant updates via WebSockets.

04

**Document Annotation**

Supports PDF and document upload with inline annotation and markup tools.

05

**AI Assistance**

Provides on-demand summarization, concept explanation, and mind-map generation.

06

**Data Persistence**

Manages all database operations, ensuring data integrity and reliable recovery.

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*Design Principle: Each module is loosely coupled and independently extendable.*

F U N C T I O N A L   R E Q U I R E M E N T S

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|    |                                                                                                                                       |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <div>User Registration &amp; Login</div> <div>Secure authentication with session management and role-based access control.</div>      |
| 02 | <div>Board Creation &amp; Management</div> <div>Create, edit, delete, and organize multiple boards within a personal workspace.</div> |
| 03 | <div>Infinite Canvas &amp; Drawing</div> <div>Freeform sketching, annotation, and sticky-note tools on an unbounded canvas.</div>     |
| 04 | <div>Real-Time Collaboration</div> <div>Simultaneous multi-user editing and viewing with live cursor presence.</div>                  |

|    |                                                                                                                                      |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 05 | <div>Document Upload &amp; Annotation</div> <div>Upload PDF and document formats; annotate and link notes directly to content.</div> |
| 06 | <div>AI Summarization &amp; Explanation</div> <div>On-demand AI processing to summarize, explain, and generate mind maps.</div>      |
| 07 | <div>Auto-Save &amp; Data Retrieval</div> <div>Automatic persistence of all canvas and note states with reliable recovery.</div>     |

# NON - FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

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## Scalability

Architecture supports multiple concurrent users without performance degradation.

## Low Latency

Real-time collaboration features maintain minimal delay during active editing sessions.

## Data Security

Robust access control, input validation, and encrypted data storage and transit.

## High Availability

System designed for reliable uptime with fault tolerance and graceful error recovery.

## Intuitive UI

Minimal learning curve through clean interface design and consistent interaction patterns.

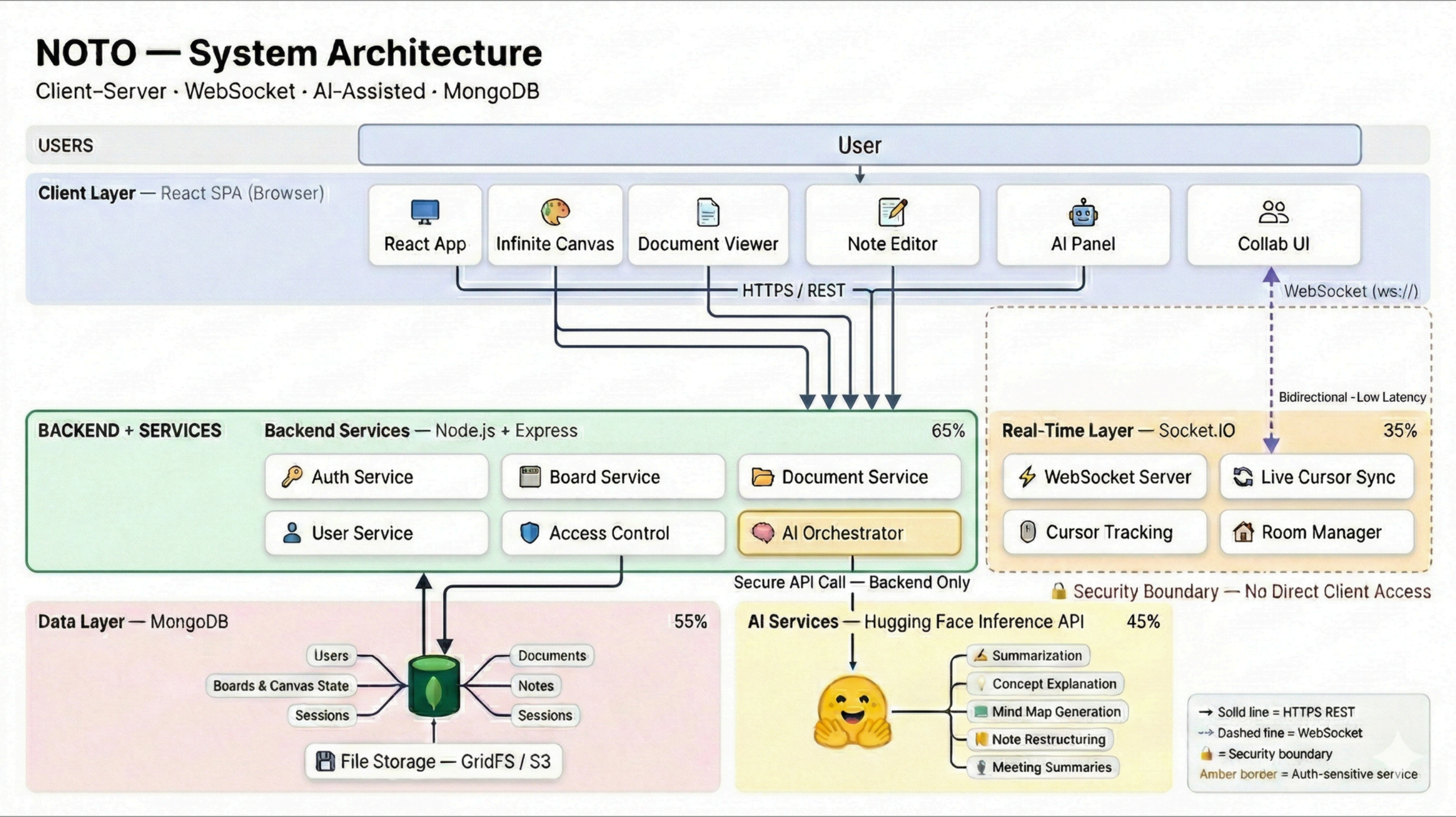
## Cross-Platform

Fully functional across all modern web browsers with no platform-specific dependencies.

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# ARCHITECTURE DIAGRAM





# HARDWARE REQUIREMENTS

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## Minimum 4 GB RAM

Ensures smooth client-side rendering and canvas operation without performance issues.

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## Standard Desktop or Laptop

No specialized or high-performance hardware is required to run the application.

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## Internet Connectivity

Required for real-time collaboration features, AI assistance, and cloud storage sync.

*Note: The system is designed to be lightweight and accessible, requiring only standard computing equipment available to most users — no specialized hardware is needed.*

SOFTWARE REQUIREMENTS

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Frontend

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**React**  
**HTML5 Canvas API**

Backend

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**Node.js**  
**Express.js**

Database

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**MongoDB**

Real-Time

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**Socket.IO**

AI Layer

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**Hugging Face Inference API**

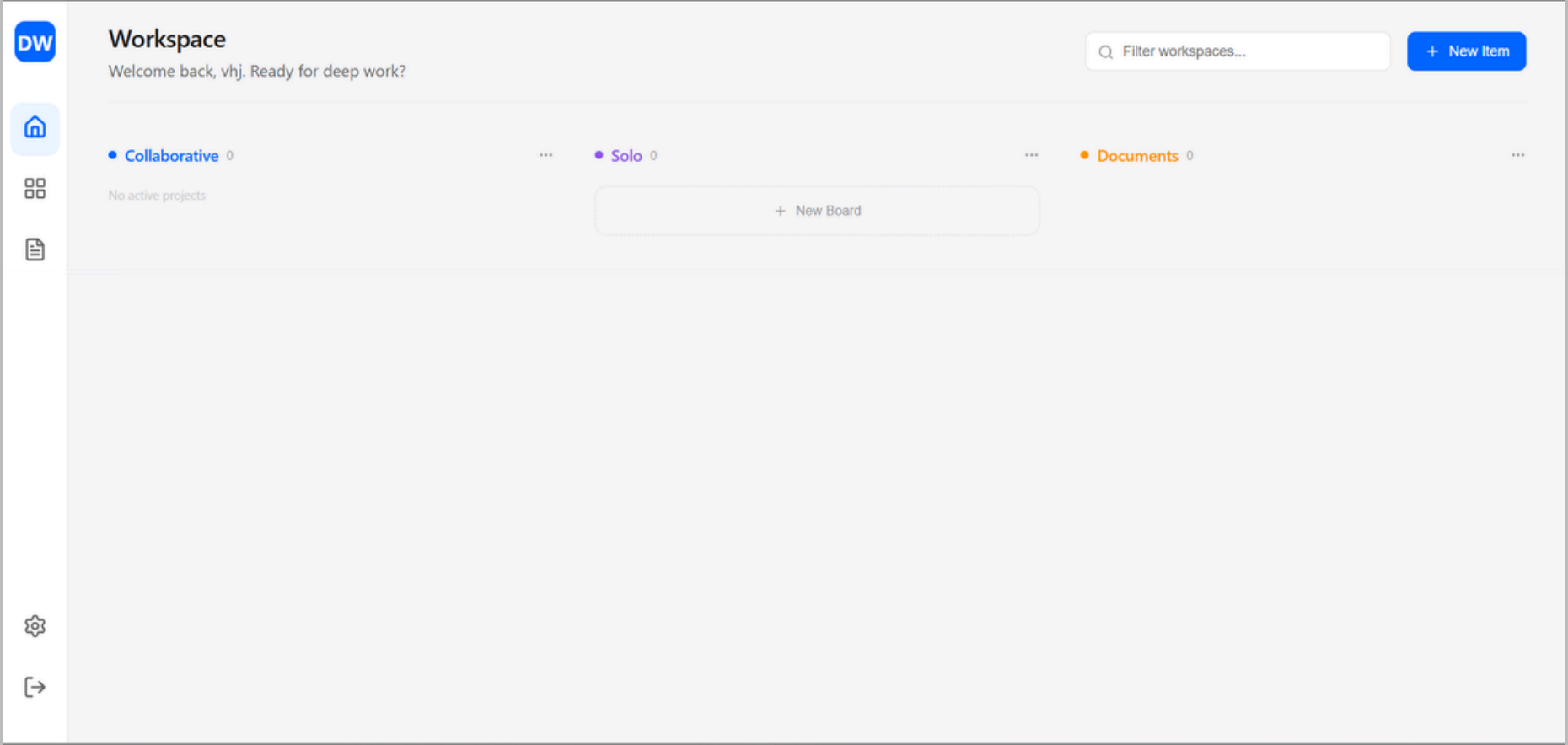
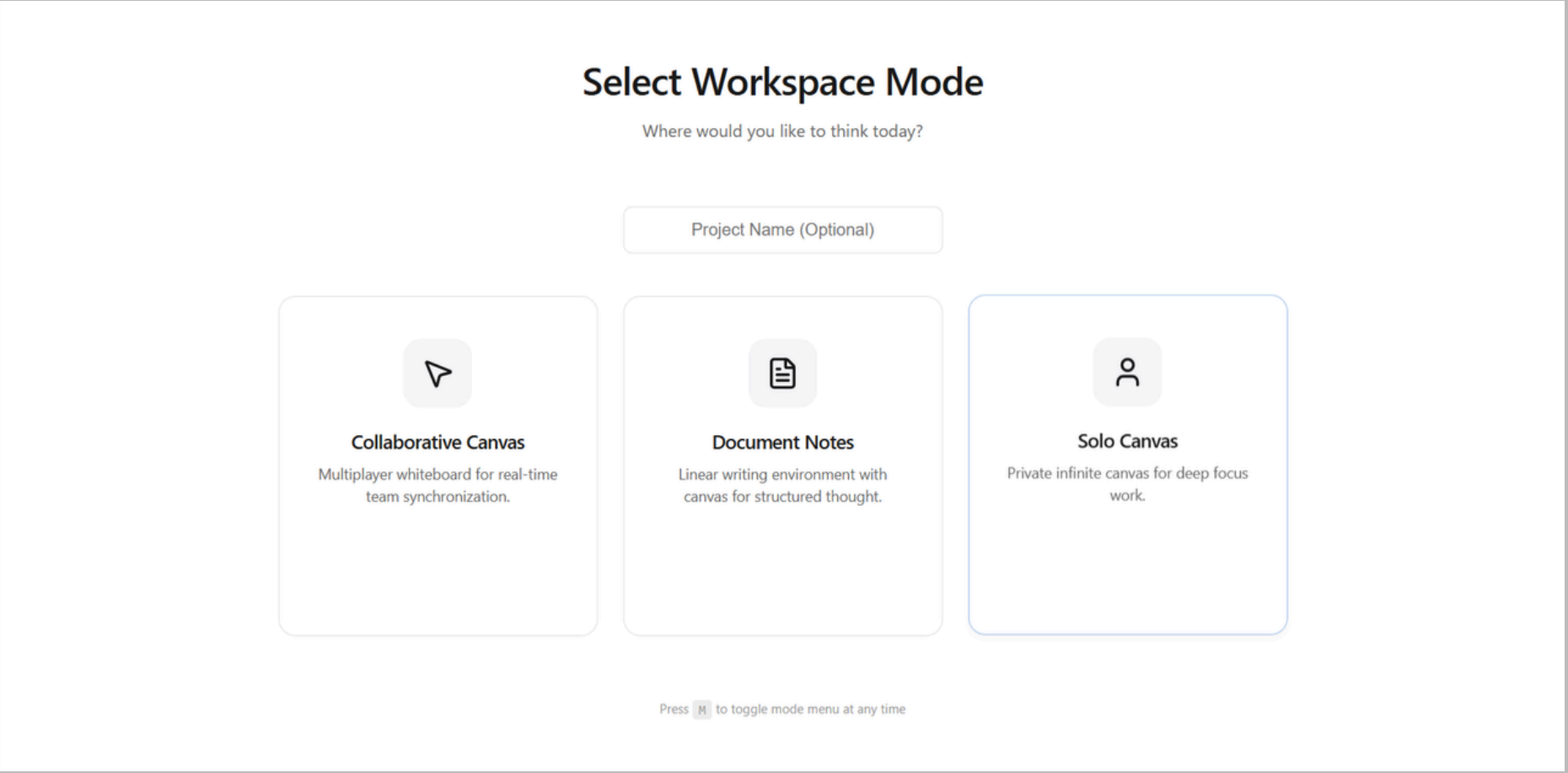
Dev Tools

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**Git**  
**Anti Gravity**

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IMPLEMENTATION







# C O N C L U S I O N

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## Problem Addressed

Noto addresses the fragmentation problem by providing a unified platform that combines an infinite canvas, document-based notes, and AI assistance in one seamless workspace.

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## Technical Approach

The modular architecture ensures scalability and maintainability, with loosely coupled components designed to be independently extended or replaced.

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## System Capabilities

The platform supports multiple usage modes — collaborative learning, individual study, and personal thinking — adapting to the diverse needs of its users.

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